UNIT: 3

PUBLICATION ETHICS & MISCONDUCTS

→ Ethics : definition
→ Ethics w.r.t science & research.
→ Intellectual honesty & research integrity.
→ Scientific misconducts
  ↳ Falsification
    Fabrication & plagiarism (FFP)
→ Redundant publications
→ ↳ duplicate & overlapping publications
  ↳ salami slicing
→ selective reporting & misinterpretation of data
→ Publication ethics :
  ↳ Introduction & importance
→ Std. setting initiative & guidelines.
  ↳ COPE
  ↳ WAME
→ conflicts of interest
→ Publication misconducts :
  ↳ definition
  ↳ concept
  ↳ unethical behaviour
→ violation of publication ethics, Authorship & contributorship
→ Identification
→ Complaints & appeals.
→ Predatory publishers & Journals.

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★ RESEARCH MISCONDUCT / SCIENTIFIC MISCONDUCTS : (FFP)

→ **Definition:**

Research misconduct is defined as fabrication falsification or plagiarism in proposing, performing or reviewing research or in reporting research results.

- **Fabrication:**

Fabrication is making up data or results & reporting them

- **Falsification:**

Falsification is manipulation of research materials, equipment or process such that the research is not accurately represented in the research method.

- **Plagrism:**

Plagiarism is the appropriation of another person's idea, processes, results or words without giving appropriate credit

★ SELF PLAGIARISM:

An author publishing the same data in more than one journal, assuming that the data, diagrams etc. are same in both publications.

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ETHICS :

→ A study of principles guiding the good of individual within the context of social interactions and community.

→ In other words, ethics are the set of rules that govern our expectations of our own and other's behaviour.

→ **Research ethics** :

Research ethics are set of ethical guidelines that guides us on how scientific research should be conducted and disseminated.

REDUNDANT PUBLICATIONS :

→ Redundant publications refers to the practice of publishing the same or substantially similar research in multiple places without proper disclosure.

→ Types of redundant publications :

(i) Duplicate publications
(ii) overlapping publications
(iii) Salami slicing.

→ **Duplicate publications** :

Duplicate publication occur when the same work is published in more than once without notifying the readers, editors etc

→ **Overlapping publications :**

Overlapping publication occurs when a manuscript shares significant content with another paper but is presented as a new study without proper citation.

→ **Salami slicing :**

Salami slicing refers to the practice of dividing a large study into several smaller papers that each report part of the findings, even though they would be better presented as a single, comprehensive study.

PUBLICATION ETHICS :

→ Publication ethics refers to principles and standards that guide the behaviour of individuals involved in publication process, including authors, editors, reviewers and publishers.

→ They encompass various aspects such as honesty in reporting research findings etc.

Importance :

(i) Integrity & credibility.
(ii) Prevention of misconduct
(iii) Recognition and Accountability.
(iv) Conflict of interest management
(v) Promotion of fairness.

STANDARD SETTING INITIATIVES

(i) COPE : Committee of publication Ethics
(ii) WAME : World Association of medical editors.

CONFLICT OF INTEREST :

→ **Definition :**

Conflict of interest occurs when an individual personal, financial or professional interests have the potential to influence their objectivity, integrity, or judgement in conducting or reporting research.

→ **Examples :**

(i) Financial ties
(ii) Personal relationships
(iii) Academic competition.

→ **Mangement of conflict of interest :**

(i) Disclosure : Researches must disclose any potential conflicts of interest to the institutions etc.

(ii) Transparency : Helps to maintain trust and credibility in research process.

(iii) Institutional Policies : Institutions should have clear policies and procedures for managing conflict of interest.

* PUBLICATION MISCONDUCT:

→ Publication misconduct refers to unethical behavior in the process of publishing scientific research.

→ This includes actions that compromise the integrity, credibility and reliability of scholarly communication.

(a) CONCEPT & PROBLEMS // WHY IT HAPPENS?

(i) Pressure to publish.
(ii) Lack of Awareness
(iii) competitive environment

(b) TYPES OF PUBLICATION MISCONDUCT:

(i) Plagiarism
(ii) Data Fabrication
(iii) Data Falsification
(iv) Inappropriate Authorship
(v) Duplicate submission
(vi) Salami slicing.

(c) CONSEQUENCES:

(i) Retractions
(ii) Loss of credibility.
(iii) Legal Actions.

→ Plagiarism detection software; peer review.

PREDATORY PUBLISHERS AND JOURNALS :

→ They are exploitative entities that prioritize self-interest over scholarly integrity.

→ They often engage in unethical practices such as misleading information, lack of proper peer review etc.

CHARACTERISTICS :

(i) Misleading information - provide false info about edit bo
(ii) Lack of peer review - By-pass peer view
(iii) Aggressive solicitation - Freq send-emails - submit f fe
(iv) High fees - chage high fees - submit

LIST OF PREDATORY IDENTIFICATION TOOLS :

(i) Beall's list
(ii) Think. check. submit
(iii) Lack of transparency.

IMPACT :

(i) Undermines scientific Integrity.
(ii) Wastes resources
(iii) Damages career.

HOW TO AVOID THEM :

(i) Research the Journal.
(ii) Consult trusted lists
(iii) Seek Advice